Did the spy agency believe there was even the slightest possibility of a Bangladesh government in exile? Perhaps even operating out of India? Senior R&AW officer N.F. Suntook was disappointed with the leaders who had fled Bangladesh; he believed they had no stature to form a government in exile. He was right. The majority of those who decided to quietly leave Bangladesh after the coup belonged to the pro-Awami League Bangladesh Chhatra League (college students). Some MPs had also crossed the border, but none had enough prominence to provide a focus for a national government in exile. Suntook wrote:

The two prominent leaders who are outside Bangladesh, namely Justice Abu Sayeed Chaudhury and Kamal Hossain, whilst personally not in favour of the developments in Bangladesh, have shown no stomach for a conflict with the regime in Bangladesh.

In the treacherous game of politics, friends and foes change their skins overnight. Chaudhury was appointed the new foreign minister of Bangladesh and he pledged allegiance to the new regime. In a meeting with a R&AW officer codenamed Shiva in New York, Chaudhury said that Kamal Hossain, who India believed was a friend, was in fact the opposite. Though Hossain outwardly expressed sentiments in favour of India, he strove to promote Pakistan's interests at the cost of India's. Chaud-hury tried to sell himself as the true friend of India. 'He said he may have to say favourable things about Pakistan, but at heart he would always work to strengthen Indo-Bangladesh relations,' Shiva told me.

Chaudhury also told Shiva that he had been advised by the president of Bangladesh to not criticise China and Pakistan in